Physical Stock Counts: Quick Reference

A physical count is the control of last resort. Count what is there, record the truth, and investigate differences instead of forcing the number to match the system.

1. Prepare

- Choose the area and freeze dispatches and receipts for it while the count runs.
- Print a count sheet from the current inventory view; include SKU, unit, location, and system quantity.
- Assign counters who do not normally work the same area when segregation is possible.

2. Count

- Count one location or bin at a time. Count sealed packs separately from loose units.
- Record quantities in the product's unit. Do not convert between units on the sheet.
- Record empty locations as zero; do not leave a line blank.
- Sign and date the sheet. A second counter should verify high-value or high-risk items.

3. Record the count

- Go to Inventory, open the product, and choose Set count.
- Enter the counted quantity, a reference such as COUNT-YYYY-MM-DD, and a note for the area or shift.
- Do not adjust the counted number to match the expected balance. The application records the variance.

4. Investigate and close

- Recount before accepting a variance. Check for unrecorded receipts, dispatches, transfers, or misplacement.
- Document the cause and the corrective action; escalate material or repeated differences.
- Have a supervisor review and sign off. Keep count sheets and movement references together.
- Watch variance trends by item and location; a repeating gap usually points to a process problem.